Tehran. We were under great anxiety about him, because he had been detained by that villain the Ameer of Bokhara, and we expected to hear of his having been murdered like poor Stoddard, Conolly and others.[78] This thief of an Ameer and he of Khiva have now murdered two of my friends. Stoddard at Bokhara and a M. Nazelli at Khiva, and if there is a war (holy war I was going to call it) to the eastward I give my father, mother and you fair notice, that it is by no means improbable that I may join the army as a volunteer. You need not be alarmed and think that I am about to break lances with some tartar or turcoman; in the first place no such war is yet talked of, nor is it likely that there will be a war in that quater, that is as long as this old animal of a Hadji is prime minister, for he has got the affairs of Persia into such a state of confusion, that he sometimes says himself that whoever is premier after him, will have eight years of hard work to undo and set to rights what he has done. The second reason is that I do not think that the Prince would let me go, there are plenty of people who can fight as well as I can, but very few who can translate newspapers. I know nothing of military matters, but, I am not a bad horseman and can use arms on horseback. —

Were you at Philadelphia during the rows they have had there?[79] I was afraid you might have had your head broken amongst them but as there was no list of killed and wounded I could not make myself sure. Your life of going backwards and forwards must be agreeable. I much wish that I could visit England for a short time, but in my present condition it is impossible. I feel that a visit to England for however short a time would do me much good, it would tend to rub off the twelve years Persian rust which has been collecting upon me. The E[ast] I[ndia] C[ompany] have lately made arrangements to facilitate the return to Europe of their civil servants, every five or six years, because they say that after this period they require a run to Europe to rub the rust off. — One thing rather comforts me — it is this that England in point of time is every day drawing nearer to Persia. I hear that Sir John Campbell the director of a steam navi[n] company has at last succeeded in sending steamers through from England to Trebizonde.[80] They come in about twenty or twenty one days; and with post horses a man may go easily from this to Trebizonde in eight or ten days—a month

[78] Col. Stoddart had been sent as an emissary by Sir John McNeil to attempt to effect the release of a number of Europeans and Russians reputed to be held in slavery at Bokhara. He was later joined by Lieut. Conolly. Both of these men were imprisoned and subsequently murdered by the Emir of Bokhara. For an "anti-government" account of the Bokhara incident, as well as for Rev. Wolff's part therein, see Capt. John Grover's work, *The Bokhara victims,* London, 1845.

[79] The so-called Protestant crusade. Between July 5–8, 1844, there occurred in Philadelphia a series of riots between native political groups and Irish Catholic immigrants.

[80] Steamboats were already a commonplace even in trans-oceanic travel. In 1839 a commission appointed by the government reported that there were 766 steam vessels registered in Great Britain, including river steamers, coasters, and offshore vessels.

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